

Illustration by **NILANJAN DAS**

enables upscaling. It has also created expertise in policy, design and implementation for renewable electricity. And also, to a large extent, expertise in pulling in private sector finance into renewable energy projects that are built now.

Becoming a global leader: These learnings, and their successful dissemination to other countries (by organisations such as the one that I lead), are the bedrock of our emerging success as a global renewable energy champion. Already, an Indian company is the cheapest EPC (engineering, procurement and construction) provider in the world. This is also true for providers of various solar applications such as solar pumps, solar cold rooms, solar mini-grids, etc. And hopefully, with the successful implementation of the performance-linked initiative (PLI) schemes, we will also be a global leader in the supply of solar cells and solar modules.

As we forge ahead, our learnings for upscaling the success of the cost-competitive RTC-RE that we have achieved, for example, through the availability of land (for solar, wind and battery projects), transmission lines (from renewable energy projects to load centres), and enabling financing–at-scale (for the higher-than–normal first costs associated with setting up solar + wind + battery capacity); for the upscaling of rooftop solar and of solar pumps (through policies that enable effective business models to provide us with electricity or water services), and for cost-reduction of green hydrogen, produced through splitting of water using renewables-based electricity, provide examples of policies that work, and companies that are willing to take the risk of investing in renewable energy technologies.

The presence of this policy, design, implementation and maintenance expertise and of risk-taking companies are together expanding India's presence in global markets. Incentives provided by the Indian governments—to enable more Indian jobs to be created—would accelerate the process. In any case, with or without incentives, this diffusion of the Indian experience, expertise and products will only increase. ■

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